

9

FORMS

Drop-down Menus

```
<select> </select>  
<option> </option>  
<optgroup> </optgroup>
```

- The **select** element creates a drop-down menu when there is no **size** attribute (or if `size="1"`).
- The **select** element contains some number of **option** elements.
- The content of the **option** element is the value sent to the server (or one can be provided with the **value** attribute).

Drop-down Menus (cont'd.)

The select menu drops down to reveal options when the user clicks on it.



What is your favorite 80s band? The Cure

```
<p>What is your favorite 80s band?
<select name="EightiesFave">
  <option>The Cure</option>
  <option>Cocteau Twins</option>
  <option>Tears for Fears</option>
  <option>Thompson Twins</option>
  <option value="EBTG">Everything But the Girl</option>
  <option>Depeche Mode</option>
  <option>The Smiths</option>
  <option>New Order</option>
</select>
</p>
```

FORM CONTROL ELEMENTS

Scrolling Menus

What 80s bands did you listen to?

The Cure
Cocteau Twins
Tears for Fears
Thompson Twins
Everything But the Girl
Depeche Mode

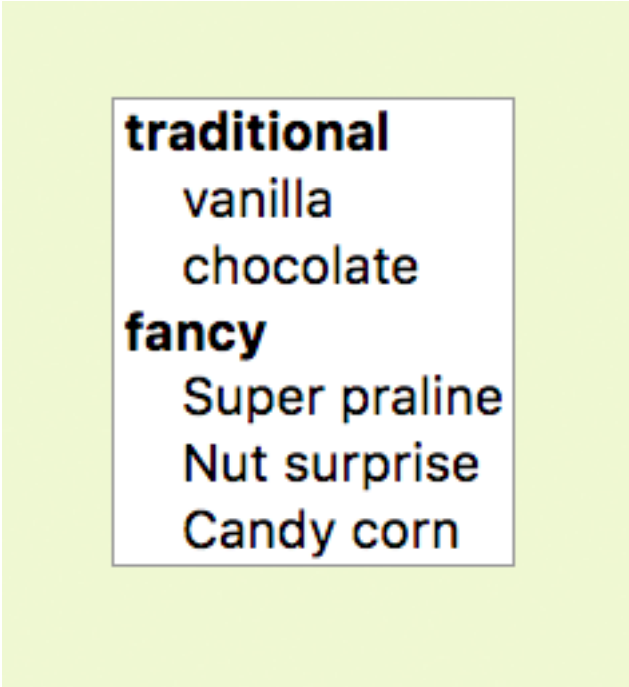
```
<p>What is your favorite 80s band?
<select name="EightiesFave" size="6" multiple>
  <option>The Cure</option>
  ...
</select>
</p>
```

- The same markup as drop-down menus, but the **size** attribute specifies how many lines to display.
- The **multiple** attribute allows more than one option to be selected.

Scrolling Menus (cont'd)

Use the **optgroup** element to create a conceptual group of options.

The **label** attribute provides the the heading for the group:



traditional
vanilla
chocolate
fancy
Super praline
Nut surprise
Candy corn

```
<select name="icecream" size="7" multiple>  
  <optgroup label="traditional">  
    <option>vanilla</option>  
    <option>chocolate</option>  
  </optgroup>  
  <optgroup label="fancy">  
    <option>Super praline</option>  
    <option>Nut surprise</option>  
    <option>Candy corn</option>  
  </optgroup>  
</select>
```

FORM CONTROL ELEMENTS

File Upload Control

`<input type="file">`

File input (on Chrome browser)

Send a photo to be used as your online icon (optional):

Choose File

No file chosen

```
<form action="/client.php" method="POST" enctype="multipart/form-data">  
  <label>Send a photo to be used as your online icon <em>(optional)</em><br>  
  <input type="file" name="photo"></label>  
</form>
```

- The file input type allows a user to select a document from their hard drive to be submitted with the form data.
- The method must be set to POST, and the encoding type must be included.

FORM CONTROL ELEMENTS

Hidden Control

```
<input type="hidden">
```

```
<input type="hidden" name="success-link"  
value="http://www.example.com/thankyou.html">
```

- Sometimes it is necessary to feed values to the processing script/app that don't come from the user.
- Hidden controls don't display in the browser.

FORM CONTROL ELEMENTS

Date and Time Controls

```
<input type="date">
```

```
<input type="time">
```

```
<input type="datetime-local">
```

```
<input type="month">
```

```
<input type="week">
```

```
<input type="date" name="birthday" value="2017-01-14">
```

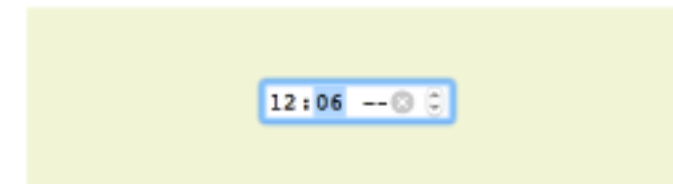
A starting value may be provided in standard date-time format.

Date and Time Controls (cont'd)

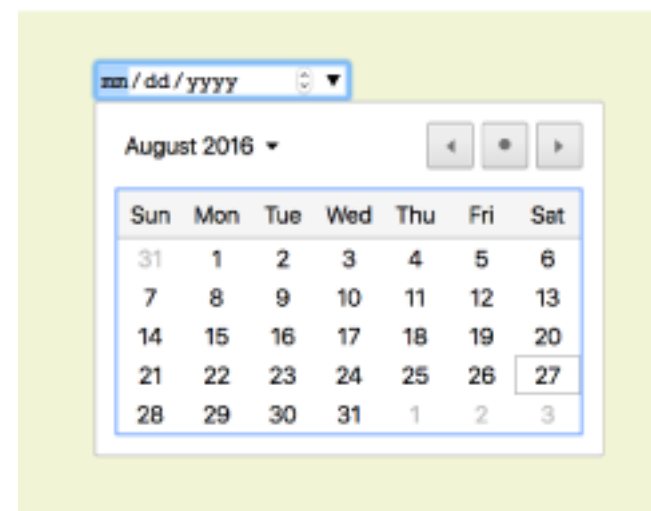
Browsers may display date and time selection widgets (not universally supported).

On non-supporting browsers, date and time inputs display as usable text-entry fields.

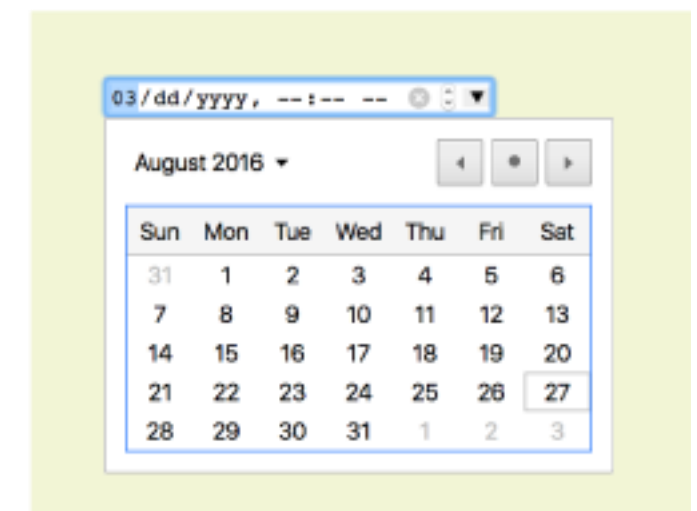
input type="time"

A screenshot of a web browser displaying an input field with the type attribute set to "time". The widget shows the time "12:06" in a blue box, with small circular arrows on either side for navigation. The entire widget is set against a light yellow background.

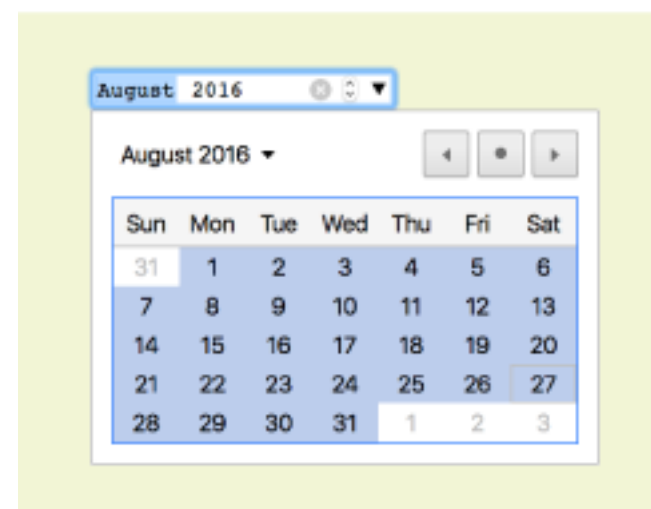
input type="date"

A screenshot of a web browser displaying an input field with the type attribute set to "date". The widget shows a date selection calendar for August 2016. The calendar has a header with the month and year, and a table of days. The day "27" is selected. The entire widget is set against a light yellow background.

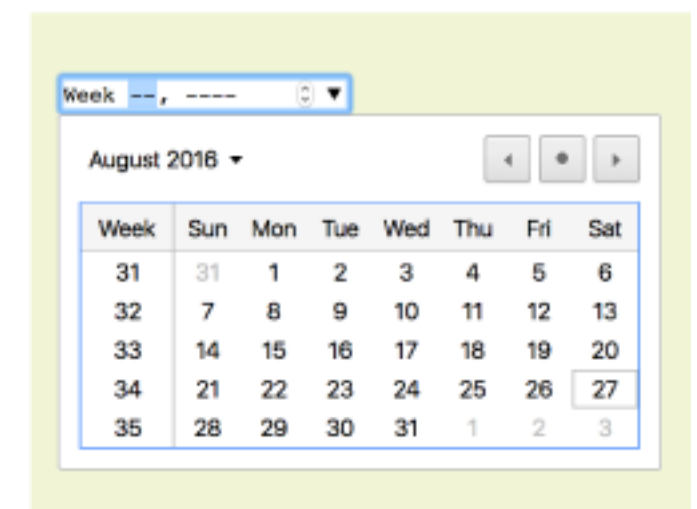
input type="datetime-local"

A screenshot of a web browser displaying an input field with the type attribute set to "datetime-local". The widget shows a date and time selection calendar for August 2016. The calendar has a header with the month and year, and a table of days. The day "27" is selected. The entire widget is set against a light yellow background.

input type="month"

A screenshot of a web browser displaying an input field with the type attribute set to "month". The widget shows a month and year selection calendar for August 2016. The calendar has a header with the month and year, and a table of days. The day "27" is selected. The entire widget is set against a light yellow background.

input type="week"

A screenshot of a web browser displaying an input field with the type attribute set to "week". The widget shows a week selection calendar for August 2016. The calendar has a header with the month and year, and a table of weeks. The week "34" is selected. The entire widget is set against a light yellow background.

FORM CONTROL ELEMENTS

Numerical Controls

```
<input type="number">
```

```
<input type="range">
```

Number and range controls collect numerical data. Browsers may render counter or slider widgets.

Both types accept **min** and **max** attributes for setting limits on the allowed values.

input type="number"

Number of guests:

input type="range"

Satisfaction (from 0 to 10):

```
<label>Number of guests <input type="number" name="guests" min="1" max="6"></label>
```

```
<label>Satisfaction (0 to 10) <input type="range" name="satisfaction" min="0" max="10" step="1"></label>
```

input type="number"

Number of guests:

input type="range"

Satisfaction (from 0 to 10):

FORM ACCESSIBILITY

Labels

`<label> </label>`

The **label** element associates a descriptive label with a form field.

Implicit association

The label text and form control are both contained within the **label** element:

```
<li><label>Red <input type="radio" name="color"
value="red"></label></li>
```

Explicit association

Matches the label with the control's ID reference using the **for** attribute:

```
<li><label for="form-colors-red">Red</label> <input type="radio"
name="color" value="red id="form-colors-red"></li>
```

Fieldsets and Legends

```
<fieldset> </fieldset>  
<legend> </legend>
```

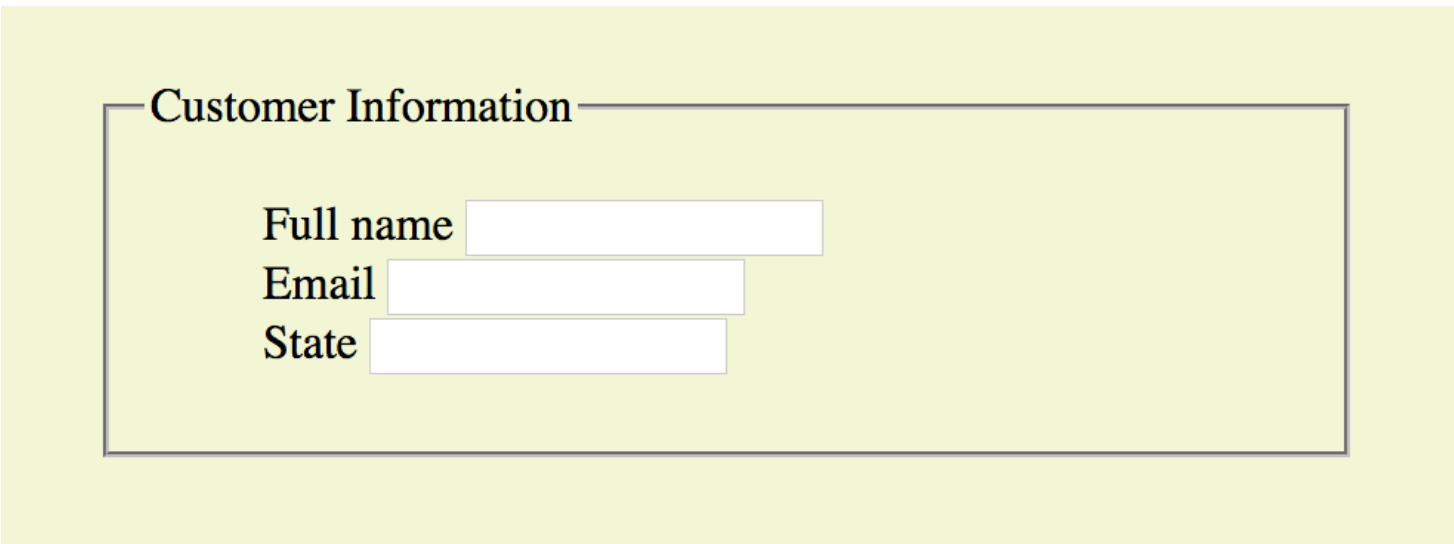
fieldset

Indicates a logical grouping of controls (examples: credit card name, number, date, etc.). By default, rendered with a box around the set of controls.

legend

Provides a caption for the enclosed fields. By default, it's displayed along the top edge of the fieldset.

Fieldsets and Legends (cont'd)



<fieldset>

<legend>Customer Information**</legend>**

<label>Full name: **<input type="text" name="fullname"></label>**

<label>Email: **<input type="text" name="email"></label>**

<label>State: **<input type="text" name="state"></label>**

</fieldset>

Form Design Tips

- Avoid unnecessary questions.
- Consider the impact of label placement. Labels above fields tend to lead to faster completion.
- Choose input types carefully.
- Group related inputs.
- Primary actions (e.g., “Buy”) should be visually dominant to secondary actions (e.g., “Back”).